

Name: _____ Date: _____

Curriculum Focus

Learning Intention

I can identify and use common nouns and proper nouns in clear sentences.

Strategy

Read the example first. Say the words aloud, notice the pattern, then try your own sentence or word sort.

Mini Lesson

A common noun names a general person, place, animal or thing. A proper noun names a specific person, place or title and begins with a capital letter. Writers choose nouns carefully so readers know exactly who or what is being described.

Vocabulary Helper

common noun - a general naming word
proper noun - a specific name
capital letter - the letter used at the start of a proper noun
precise noun - a noun that gives clear information

Model Example

Common noun: city -> Proper noun: Melbourne
Common noun: river -> Proper noun: Murray River
Common noun: teacher -> Proper noun: Mr Patel
Sentence: Maya visited Sydney during the school holidays.

Quick Practice

Write two common nouns and turn each into a proper noun. Then write one sentence using one proper noun correctly.

Answer: _____

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Warm Up

Circle the proper noun in each pair: school / Sunshine Primary, river / Yarra River, girl / Ava, country / Australia.

My answer: _____

Build Your Skills

Write four sentences. Each sentence must include one common noun and one proper noun. Check capital letters carefully.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Strong Challenge

Rewrite this sentence with stronger nouns: The child went to the place with an animal. Add at least two proper nouns.

I Can Checklist

- ☐ I read the example carefully.
- ☐ I used the target skill.
- ☐ I checked spelling and punctuation.

High Five

Strong effort. You slowed down, checked the pattern and improved your writing like a confident learner.

Teacher Feedback

What went well: _____

Next step: _____

Teacher Notes

Focus on whether the student can identify and use common nouns and proper nouns in clear sentences. Encourage students to explain their thinking and check their work aloud.

Answer Guide / Sample Responses

Answers will vary. Correct responses should show common nouns as general names and proper nouns as specific names with capital letters. Example: The student visited Melbourne Museum with Uncle Ben.

Parent Tip - At Home

At home, ask your child to sort names around the house into common nouns and proper nouns, such as street, Ballarat Road, shop and Woolworths.

Teacher Tip - In Class

Use a quick noun hunt. Students list classroom common nouns, then convert some to proper nouns using people, places and book titles.

Mini Rubric and Next Step

Mini rubric:

- 4 - Clear understanding, accurate use and careful checking.
- 3 - Good understanding with minor errors.
- 2 - Beginning skill; needs more support or examples.
- 1 - Needs guided practice and teacher modelling.

Next step: practise one more example, then explain the choice aloud.